

WhatsApp Privacy User Guide

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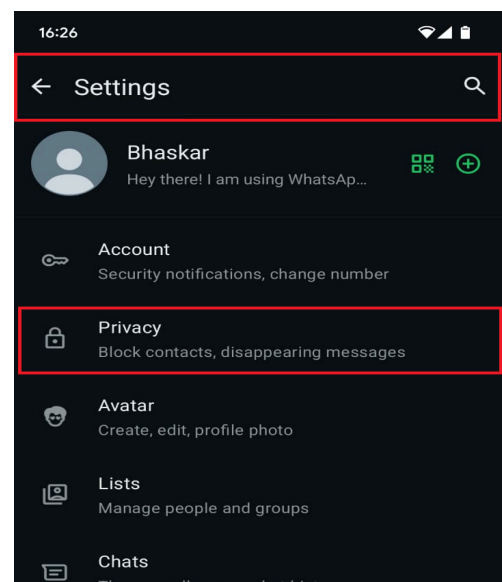
1.0 WhatsApp privacy

You can control your privacy on **WhatsApp**. Using privacy settings on WhatsApp, you can control who gets to see your personal information. *Once set, the settings apply to both the WhatsApp app on your cell phone and the WhatsApp web application.*

2.0 Set up your privacy

To view available privacy settings on WhatsApp, follow the steps below.

1. Select **Settings** on your WhatsApp.
Select **Privacy** next.
Navigate to WhatsApp and select **Settings > Privacy**.



2. Privacy settings in WhatsApp are grouped under different categories:
 - a. Who can see my personal info
 - b. Disappearing messages
 - c. Advanced
 - d. Privacy checkup

Each category is detailed in a separate table that shows:

- a. Application where setting is available: WhatsApp mobile app or WhatsApp Web.
- b. setting
- c. subsetting
- d. brief description and
- e. steps to set up

2.1 Who can see my personal info					
	Application	Setting	Subsetting	Description	Steps to set up
1	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Last seen and online	Who can see my last seen	Choose who can view when you were last seen on WhatsApp.	Select one of: 1. "Everyone": If you want everyone to view your last seen. 2. "My Contacts": If you want only your contacts to view your last seen. 3. "Contacts except": If you want your contacts to view your last seen, except for a selected set of contacts. 4. "Nobody": If you want no one to view your last seen.

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					If you do not share your last seen information, you will not be able to see other people's last seen information.
2	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Last seen and online	Who can see when I'm online	Choose who can view your online presence on WhatsApp.	Select one of: 1. "Everyone": If you want everyone to know when you are online. 2. "My Contacts": If you want only your contacts to know when you are online. If you do not share your online presence, you will not be able to see other people's online presence.
3	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Profile photo		Choose who can view your profile picture.	Select one of: 1. "Everyone": If you want everyone to view your profile picture. 2. "My Contacts": If you want only your contacts to view your profile picture. 3. "Contacts except": If you want your contacts to view

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					your profile picture, except for a selected set of contacts. 4. "Nobody": If you want no one to view your profile picture.
4	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	About		Choose who can view information about you.	Select one of: 1. "Everyone": If you want everyone to view information about you. 2. "My Contacts": If you want only your contacts to view information about you. 3. "Contacts except": If you want your contacts to view information about you, except for a selected set of contacts. 4. "Nobody": If you want no one to view information about you.
5	WhatsApp mobile app,	Status		Choose who can view	Select one of: 1. "My Contacts": If you want your

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	WhatsApp Web			your status information.	status to be shared with all your contacts. 2. "Contacts except": If you want your status to be shared with all your contacts, except for a selected set of contacts. 3. "Only share with": If you want your status to be shared with a selected set of contacts.
6	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Read receipts		Send a read receipt when you read a message.	Turn on this setting if you want to send a read receipt when you read a message. By default, this setting is turned on. Turn off this setting if you do not want to send a read receipt when you read a message. If turned off, you won't send or receive read receipts. Read receipts are always sent for group chats.

2.2 Disappearing messages

	Application	Setting	Subsetting	Description	Steps to set up
1.	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Disappearing messages	Default message timer	Start new chats with a disappearing message timer set to a duration you select. Choose how long you want chats to be retained.	If you want messages to be deleted from conversations automatically after a period of time, select one of the below: 1. 24 hours 2. 7 days 3. 90 days 4. Off When turned on, all new individual chats will start with disappearing messages set to the duration you select. This setting will not affect your existing chats.

2.3 Additional privacy settings

	Application	Setting	Subsetting	Description	Steps to set up
1.	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Groups		Choose who can add you to a WhatsApp group.	Choose one of: 1. Everyone: If you want everyone to add you to a WhatsApp group. 2. My contacts: If you want any of your contacts to

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					add you to a WhatsApp group. 3. My contacts except: If you want any of your contacts to add you to a WhatsApp group except for a selected set of contacts.
2.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Live Location		Enable or disable live location sharing.	
3.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Calls		Block calls from unknown numbers. Unknown numbers may be someone who you have never contacted before or saved as a contact.	By default, this setting allows calls from unknown numbers. Turn on this setting to block unknown callers.
4.	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Blocked contacts		Block a contact. View phone numbers of blocked contacts	“Add blocked contact” by selecting a contact. Blocked contacts will no longer be able to call you or send you messages. To unblock a blocked contact, delete it from the blocked

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					contacts list.
5.	WhatsApp Web	App Lock		Require a password to unlock WhatsApp. When enabled, you need to enter your password to unlock WhatsApp.	This setting is disabled by default. Check “ App lock ” to enable this setting. Enter device password. Re-enter device password.
6.	WhatsApp mobile app	App Lock	Unlock with biometric	When enabled, you will need to use a fingerprint, face, or other unique identifiers to open WhatsApp.	This setting is turned off by default.
7.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Chat Lock		Require a password to unlock a chat. When enabled, you need to enter your password to unlock a chat.	

2.4 Advanced privacy settings

	Application	Setting	Subsetting	Description	Steps to set up
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2.4 Advanced privacy settings

1.	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Block unknown account messages		To protect your account and improve device performance, WhatsApp will block messages from unknown accounts if they exceed a certain volume.	This setting is turned off by default. Turn on the setting to enable this feature.
2.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Protect IP address in calls		To make it harder for people to infer your location, calls on this device will be securely relayed through WhatsApp servers. This will reduce call quality.	This setting is turned off by default. Turn on this setting to enable this feature.
3.	WhatsApp mobile app, WhatsApp Web	Disable link previews		To help protect your IP address from being inferred by third-party websites, previews for the links you share in chats will no longer be generated.	This setting is turned off by default. Turn on the setting to enable this feature.

3.0 Privacy checkup

Privacy checkup is an umbrella feature you can use to review and set up all privacy settings in one place. This feature includes the below categories described earlier:

1. Choose who can contact you
2. Who can see my personal info
3. Additional privacy settings
4. Advanced privacy settings

Therefore, you can start from the privacy checkup to:

1. Review and
2. Set up all privacy settings in one place.

3.1 Privacy checkup settings					
	Application	Setting	Subsetting	Description	Steps to set up
1.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Choose who can contact you	Groups Silence unknown callers Blocked contacts		Refer to the “ Additional settings ” table above.
2.	WhatsApp mobile app only	Control your personal info	Profile photo Last seen and online Read receipts		Refer to the “ Who can see your personal info ” table above.

4.0 FAQs

1. I am unable to view last seen and online presence for my contacts.
 - A. If you have turned off sharing your last seen and online presence, you cannot view other people's last seen and online presence.
2. I am unable to see **Chat Lock** on WhatsApp Web. Why?

This feature is available on the WhatsApp mobile app only.
3. I am unable to see **Live Location** on WhatsApp Web. Why?

This feature is available on the WhatsApp mobile app only.
4. How do I enable **Live Location** on WhatsApp?

You need to enable location on your mobile phone first via device settings.
Once you complete that, you can enable **Live Location** on WhatsApp.
5. I want to block a contact. How do I do this?

Navigate to **Settings > Privacy > Advanced > Blocked Contacts**.
Click **Add contact**.
Choose a contact to block.
6. I want to unblock a phone number that I blocked accidentally. How do I do this?

Navigate to **Settings > Privacy > Advanced > Blocked contacts**.
Select the phone number that you blocked.

Select **Unblock**.